



# HOURLY BILLING IS **KILLING** YOUR AUTHORITY

*"My rate is \$150 an hour. I think it's fair given my experience and the time it takes."*

How long will the project take?

Maybe 20 hours. So \$3k.

My intern quoted me \$80/hr. I'll go with them.

## THE TRAP

**Hourly billing puts you in a price war with juniors.**

When you sell time, the buyer compares your hour to theirs.





HOURLY

**Sells  
Labour  
By Time**



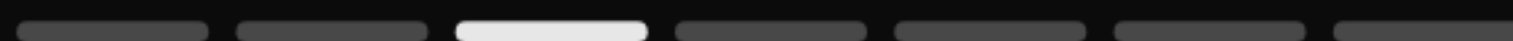
OUTCOME

**Sells  
Result  
By Value**

## THE SHIFT

**Buyers don't want your hours. They want the outcome at the end of them.**

Price the transformation, not the time. Authority lives in the result, not the clock.



# 4 invisible taxes you pay for billing by the hour



## The Comparison Tax

Your \$300 hour gets benchmarked against a junior at \$80. The buyer can't see your decade of pattern recognition. They only see the unit.



## The Speed Penalty

You get faster, sharper, more experienced — and you make less per project. Hourly rewards inefficiency and punishes mastery.



## The Ceiling Tax

There are only 168 hours in a week. Hourly billing puts a hard cap on what you can ever earn, no matter how good you become.



## The Authority Tax

Premium experts price the outcome. Junior freelancers price the hour. Your billing model tells the buyer which one you are.

THE MIRROR

Hourly model vs outcome model. Same expert. Different ceiling.

| ELEMENT     | HOURLY      | OUTCOME     |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| Sold        | Time        | Result      |
| Compared to | Juniors     | ROI         |
| Faster work | Loses money | Wins margin |
| Ceiling     | 168 hrs/wk  | No ceiling  |
| Buyer sees  | A vendor    | An expert   |

## THE MOVE

# Replace your hourly rate in 3 sharp steps

- 1 Name The Outcome**  
Write the exact result the buyer pays for. Not "coaching sessions" — "stopped discounting in 60 days." The unit of value is the outcome.
- 2 Price The Transformation**  
Anchor the price to what that outcome is worth, not how long it takes you. A two-hour breakthrough is not a two-hour fee.
- 3 Refuse Hourly Asks**  
When a buyer asks for your hourly rate, redirect to the outcome. "We don't bill by the hour. Here's what the result costs." End of negotiation.

### PRO TIP

If a buyer insists on hourly, they're not buying expertise — they're buying a body. Send them to a freelancer site.

**Comment  
"BRAND"**

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